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Culture (OWC): [Tonga \(FQ12\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Southern Africa

Field Date: 1949, 1956-1957

Coverage Date: 1950-1957

Place Coverage: Eastern Southern Province, Zambia

Section Title(S)

Internal Organization of the Neighbourhood

Such attempts at concerted action usually have little success since those opposed can block a decision. Moreover no man feels himself bound by the decision of any gathering unless he has participated in it. Usually he also expects to be personally instructed in recognition of his right to be there. Each man repeats a decision or an important point to the next in line, until all present have been instructed. A general announcement or open discussion is not enough. If a decision is made in his absence or if he is not personally instructed, then he is entitled to ignore whatever action or decision is agreed upon. Even if he approves it, he may feel that his dignity calls upon him to ignore the result. This is known as *kutakata*, a reaction deeply engrained in many spheres of life. Most Valley people, for instance, do not feel that any agreement made by headman, senior headman, chief or the Native Authority is binding upon them unless they were present and took part in the agreement.

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Other Forms of Social Control. The links between lineages, which operate to maintain the peace, are constantly being readjusted, since they depend upon marriages and the birth of children. As the old links vanish, new marriages establish new ties between the same groups of people, but they do not lead to any permanent statement of how the various groups should act towards one another.

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In each region of the Valley, a more permanent framework is given by a linkage between certain groups or categories of people. These linkages are not stated in kinship terms, and when actual kinship intervenes the relationship goes into abeyance.

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In the Middle River and Upland regions, the framework is provided by the system of clan joking-partners. Upper River clans do not have joking-partners, with the possible exception of the Baleya and Bantanga, but instead a lineage is linked with 178 various others of its own clan in a permanent alliance as *silufulo* partners. *Silufulo* can be translated as ‘calabash man’ and refers to the calabash ladle with which offerings are poured.

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